CAFÉ COM DADOS & GATOS

Hermes Agent on WSL2

Installation, Hermes exploration, and practical project

Course in 4 lessons - 2026 Edition

Windows 11 - WSL2 - Ubuntu - Ollama - Hermes Agent

Educational material from the Café com Dados & Gatos channel

How this course works

Four lessons, four clear achievements.

The correct course structure

Lesson 1 goes from installing WSL2 and Ollama to the first prompt answered by Hermes. Lesson 2 introduces the Hermes panels, menus, and options. Lesson 3 goes deeper into Profiles, external memory, Codex, subagents, Kanban, Cron, and A2A. Lesson 4 closes the course with remote access and multiple users, creating and using Skills, and integration with MCP servers.

Lesson 1 goes from installing WSL2 and Ollama to the first prompt answered by Hermes. Lesson 2 introduces the Hermes panels, menus, and options. Lesson 3 uses the agent to create a complete project.

Lesson map

1. Install everything and run the first prompt

WSL2, Ubuntu, Ollama, Cloud model, Hermes, configuration, Dashboard, and first conversation.

2. Get to know Hermes from the inside

Status, Chat, sessions, settings, keys, scheduled tasks, skills, tools, memory, logs, and the other panels.

3. How to set up and test advanced Hermes

Profiles, external memory, OpenViking, Hindsight, Codex, subagents, Kanban, Cron, and A2A. Planning, creation, testing, backup, and optional AI, always interacting with Hermes.

4. Remote access, Skills, and MCP

Remote access and multiple users, creating and using Skills, and integration with MCP servers. Planning, creation, testing, backup, and optional AI, always interacting with Hermes.

What is not required

- Docker will not be installed or used in this course.
- You do not need to know how to program to follow the project creation process.
- You do not need to edit YAML files manually during the lessons.
- Advanced features will be explained without requiring you to enable them.

> *Important*
>
> *The Hermes interface evolves quickly. Panel names or their order may change slightly between versions. The usage logic, however, remains the same.*

Before you begin

You need

- ☐ Updated Windows 11.
- ☐ Administrator permission to install WSL2.
- ☐ Virtualization enabled on the computer.
- ☐ Internet connection.
- ☐ Approximately 15 GB of free space.
- ☐ An Ollama account to use the Cloud model.

Golden rule of the course

Work only inside the course folder.

All project files will stay in ~/hermes-lab. This prevents the agent from working on personal documents or in other folders on the computer.

Reference environment

This edition was organized for Windows 11, Ubuntu 24.04 LTS on WSL2, Ollama for Windows, and Hermes Agent. Because the tools receive frequent updates, confirm the version displayed on your computer during the recording.

LESSON 1

Install everything and talk to Hermes

From an empty Windows setup to the first prompt answered by the agent.

> *By the end of this lesson, you will have:*
>
> *Ubuntu running on WSL2, Ollama connected, Hermes configured, and a first conversation open in the browser.*

1. Understand the environment

Each part has a simple role.

Windows

It is the main operating system. The browser and the Ollama application run there.

WSL2

It is the Windows feature that lets you run Linux inside your computer.

Ubuntu

It is the Linux environment where Hermes will be installed.

Ollama

It receives the request from Hermes and connects the course to the selected model.

Hermes Agent

It is the agent that chats, uses tools, and helps create the project.

> *Lesson flow*
>
> *You talk to Hermes in the browser. Hermes runs in Ubuntu. Ubuntu accesses Ollama on Windows. Ollama sends the request to the Cloud model.*

2. Install WSL2 and Ubuntu

Open PowerShell as administrator

Right-click the Start menu and choose Terminal (Admin) or PowerShell (Admin).

Check the current status

```
wsl --status
wsl --list --verbose
```

Install Ubuntu when necessary

```
wsl --install -d Ubuntu-24.04
```

> *During the first launch*
>
> *Create a username and password for Ubuntu. The password does not display dots or asterisks while you type. This is normal.*

Confirm that the version is 2

```
wsl --list --verbose
```

On the Ubuntu line, the VERSION column must show 2.

3. Prepare Ollama on Windows

Install the application

Download and install Ollama for Windows from the official website. Then open the application and sign in to your account.

Confirm the installation in PowerShell

```
ollama --version
```

Sign in and prepare the model

```
ollama signin
ollama pull gemma4:cloud
ollama list
```

> *Cloud model*
>
> *The name ends in `:cloud` because inference takes place in Ollama's infrastructure. The small manifest that is downloaded is not a complete local model.*

4. Test the connection from Ubuntu

Open Ubuntu and run the tests below. They confirm that the Linux environment can communicate with Ollama running on Windows.

```
curl http://localhost:11434/api/version
curl http://localhost:11434/api/tags
```

Expected results

- The first command shows the Ollama version.
- The second shows the list of available models.

When it does not work

Connection refused

Confirm that the Ollama application is open on Windows and restart WSL.

Model missing

Run ollama pull gemma4:cloud again in PowerShell.

Authentication error

Run ollama signin again and confirm the account in the browser.

5. Create the safe course folder

```
mkdir -p ~/hermes-lab
cd ~/hermes-lab
pwd
```

The result of pwd must end in /hermes-lab.

> *Do not use other folders*
>
> *Do not run the project in `/`, `/home`, the entire user folder, or personal Windows documents.*

6. Install and configure Hermes

Official installation

```
curl -fsSL https://hermes-agent.nousresearch.com/install.sh | bash
```

If the setup wizard does not open automatically, run:

```
hermes setup
```

Configuration used in the course

- Choose **Custom Endpoint**.
- Enter `http://localhost:11434/v1`.
- Leave the API Key empty or use `no-key`, depending on what the wizard allows.
- Enter `gemma4:cloud` as the model.
- Finish the wizard.

Refresh the terminal and verify

```
source ~/.bashrc
hermes version
hermes doctor
```

> *Stop when there is an error*
>
> *If `hermes doctor` reports a problem, do not continue just to "see whether it works." Read the message and fix the indicated cause.*

7. Open the Dashboard and Chat

Inside Ubuntu, in the ~/hermes-lab folder, run:

```
hermes dashboard --tui
```

Open this address in the Windows browser:

```
http://127.0.0.1:9119
```

> *Why use 127.0.0.1?*
>
> *This address restricts the Dashboard to the local computer. The course does not use `--insecure` and does not expose the panel to the network.*

First launch

The interface may take some time to compile and open the first time. Wait for the availability message before repeatedly refreshing the page.

8. Open Hermes Desktop (optional)

Desktop is an optional graphical interface. On WSL2, it depends on WSLg, the Linux graphical integration with Windows.

Inside Ubuntu, in the ~/hermes-lab folder, run:

```
cd ~/hermes-lab
hermes desktop
```

When the window appears but does not open

On some computers, the window may appear on the taskbar but fail to load correctly. First terminate possible stuck processes in Ubuntu:

```
pkill -f Hermes
pkill -f electron
pkill -f chromium
```

Then close Ubuntu. In Windows PowerShell, run:

```
wsl --shutdown
```

Open Ubuntu again and try to start Desktop:

```
cd ~/hermes-lab
hermes desktop
```

If Desktop still does not load, the lesson can continue through the Dashboard without any loss.

9. Run the first prompt

Open the Chat panel and send this simple message:

> *Explain in simple language where you are running, which model is configured, and what types of tasks you can perform. Do not modify files and do not run commands.*

What to observe

- Hermes answered inside the browser.
- The configured model was recognized.
- No tool needed approval.
- No file was created or modified.

> *Lesson 1 achievement*
>
> *You installed WSL2, prepared Ubuntu, connected Ollama, installed Hermes, opened the Dashboard, and received the first response.*

Lesson 1 checklist

- ☐ Ubuntu appears with VERSION 2.
- ☐ Ollama responds from inside Ubuntu.
- ☐ `gemma4:cloud` appears in the list.
- ☐ `hermes doctor` does not show a blocking error.
- ☐ The Dashboard opens at `127.0.0.1:9119`.
- ☐ Desktop was tested, or the Dashboard was kept as the alternative.
- ☐ The first prompt received a response.

Content translated from Portuguese into English by AI.